

Ἀνώνυμος μαγικά συγγράμματα

Magical Papyri and Anonymous Late Antique Ritual Texts

eul_aid: smk

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Κοινή τεχνική [Technical Koine](#)
Domain: Ἐπιστήμη [Science](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)

Magical Treatises Anonymous Life

No biographical information exists for the anonymous compilers of the magical treatises from the 2nd to 4th centuries CE. These practical handbooks originate from the Greco-Roman world of Late Antiquity, a period of religious syncretism. The texts imply literate practitioners, such as temple scribes or ritual experts, operating where magic intersected with religion, philosophy, and proto-scientific thought.

Works

The works are corpora of magical recipes and rituals. The primary corpus is the Greek Magical Papyri, a modern collection of papyri from Egypt, with a concentration from the 2nd to 4th centuries CE. Key papyri include the "Eighth Book of Moses," the "Great Magical Papyrus," and the "Lithika." Related collections include the Demotic Magical Papyri and Coptic magical texts.

Significance

These treatises are primary sources for ancient religion, magic, and daily life. They provide direct evidence for ritual practices and syncretic beliefs, blending Egyptian, Greek, Jewish, and early Christian elements. They are crucial for understanding the boundaries between religion, magic, and science in the ancient world.

Works (4)

- [Μαγικά Πάπυροι](#) · [Magical Papyri](#) · 240 passages
- [Μαγικά Πάπυροι Χριστιανικά Ἀποσπάσματα](#) · [Magical Papyri Christian Fragments](#) · 32 passages
- [Μαγικά Πάπυροι](#) · [Magical Papyri, Ostraca](#) · 4 passages
- [Μαγικά Πάπυροι](#) · [Magical Papyri, Tablets](#) · 3 passages